Environment Variables

Security & Configuration Protocol

Chewe Technologies (pvt) LTD

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.ENV Configuration Manual

The `.env` file is the most critical file in the system architecture. It contains the master keys, database credentials, and secret routes that make the application function. Under absolutely no circumstances should this file ever be pushed to GitHub or shared publicly.

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1. Backend Configuration (NestJS)

These variables must be placed in the `/backend/.env` file on the production server.

Database Configuration

```
DB_HOST=localhost
DB_PORT=5432
DB_USERNAME=postgres
DB_PASSWORD=your_secure_password
DB_DATABASE=chewe_prod
```

These variables instruct TypeORM exactly how to connect to the PostgreSQL daemon running on the VPS.

Security & JWT

```
JWT_SECRET=a_very_long_randomized_string_!@#
JWT_EXPIRATION=24h
```

The JWT Secret is used to mathematically sign user sessions. If this secret is ever leaked, malicious users could forge login tokens. Change it immediately if compromised.

Third-Party Integrations (AI & SMTP)

```
OPENROUTER_API_KEY=sk-or-v1-abcdef...
SMTP_USER=contact.chewetechnologies@gmail.com
SMTP_PASSWORD=abcd efgh ijkl mnop
```

The OpenRouter key grants access to the AI models. The SMTP variables are required for Nodemailer to dispatch "Forgot Password" reset emails. The SMTP password must be an App Password, not your standard Gmail password.

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2. Frontend Configuration (Vite)

These variables must be placed in the root `/.env` file.

```
VITE_API_URL=https://ct.chewetechnologies.co.zw/api
```

This tells the React application where to send its fetch requests. In production, this must point to the Nginx reverse proxy endpoint. Locally, it can point to `http://localhost:5000`.

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